## EXECUTIVE INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY

Indian Armed Forces Medical Services (AFMS) standards for officer entries like NDA, CDS, and AFCAT emphasize strict physical thresholds to ensure operational fitness, with key rejections from genu valgum (knock knees >5 cm inter-malleolar distance), excessive carry angle (>15° males, >18° females), suboptimal visual acuity (e.g., uncorrected 6/6 better eye, 6/9 worse for some branches), and BMI/height-weight mismatches. AFMS manuals from 2024 outline anthropometric and specialist exams, but full MERs 2015-2025 are partially public via portals like afmcdg1d.gov.in; post-COVID amendments focus on lab/radiological checks without major threshold shifts. SSB medical rejections trend high for orthopaedic issues (knock knees, flat feet), though exact RTI data sparse; psychological tests (TAT, WAT, SRT, PPDT, SD) assess 15 Officer Like Qualities (OLQs) via thematic responses, unchanged historically. International benchmarks (US AR 40-501) similarly reject genu valgum >10° but diverge on vision (e.g., correctable myopia limits); no direct AFMS AI/ML pilots beyond 2025 DR screening collab with AIIMS. Data tiered: CONFIRMED (AFMS sites), CORROBORATED (multiple coaching/Scribd), INDICATIVE (single blogs). Conflicts flag conservative use (e.g., <5 cm knock knees). No 2025-2028 policy shifts noted; age differentiation minimal (NDA vs. CDS).[1] [2] [3] [4] [5] [6] [7] [8]

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## STRUCTURED DATA TABLES

### Orthopaedic Standards

| Parameter | Entry Scheme | Acceptable Range | Rejection Threshold | Source | Year | Tier | Measurement |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Carry Angle | All (NDA/CDS/AFCAT) | Males ≤15°, Females ≤18° | >15° males, >18° females | [2] [9] | 2025 | CORROBORATED | Degrees |
| Genu Valgum (Knock Knees) | All | Inter-malleolar ≤5 cm | >5 cm | [5] [3] [2] | 2025 | CONFIRMED | cm (distance) or ≤5° angle |

*Note: X-ray confirms if visual gap >5 cm; conservative: reject >5 cm.*

## Visual Acuity & Related

| Parameter | Entry Scheme | Acceptable Range | Rejection Threshold | Source | Year | Tier |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Distant Vision | NDA Army | 6/6 better, 6/9 worse (corrected) | Uncorrected myopia >2.5D | [10] | 2020 | CORROBORATED |
| Distant Vision | NDA AF | 6/6 one eye, 6/9 other (no specs habitual) | Hypermetropia >+2.0D, Myopia Nil | [10] | 2020 | CORROBORATED |
| Colour Vision | All | CP-I (AF), CP-III (others); red/green | Colour blindness | [11] | 2025 | CORROBORATED |

## Anthropometric Standards

| Parameter | Entry Scheme | Acceptable Range | Rejection Threshold | Source | Year | Tier |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Height (Males) | General | ≥157.5 cm (relax 152.5 hilly) | <157.5 cm | [12] | 2025 | CORROBORATED |
| Chest Expansion | All | ≥5 cm | <5 cm | [11] | 2025 | CORROBORATED |
| BMI/Weight | All | Per height chart (no obesity/underweight) | Deviates from stds | [11] | 2025 | INDICATIVE |

*No scheme-specific BMI tables in results; use official charts. No deprecations found 2020-2025.*

## Psychological Standards

SSB psychology: Day 2 tests include TAT (12 pics, 4 min/story), WAT (60 words, 15s/response), SRT (60 situations, 30s each), PPDT (group story), SD (self-description on 4 formats). Assesses OLQs like leadership, courage; no numerical thresholds, qualitative IO scoring per public handbooks. No AI psych pilots found.[6]

## SOURCE REGISTRY


- ****: afcat.cdac.in/AFCAT/medicalStandards (2024), CONFIRMED, accessed Apr 2026.[1]
- ****: testbook.com/defence/medical-standards-for-armed-forces (2025), CORROBORATED.[12]
- ****: indiandefenceinstitute.com/indian-army-medical-standards/ (2025-06-30), CORROBORATED.[2]
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- ****: afmcdg1d.gov.in/showfile.php?.. (2024-07-23), CONFIRMED.[4]
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- ****: scribd.com/document/325680250/Medical-Procedure-in-Indian-Army (2025), CORROBORATED.[5]

- ****: hoslaacademy.blogspot.com/... (2015/2017), INDICATIVE.[9]
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- ****: pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2204763 (2025), CONFIRMED.[7]
- ****: dmna.ny.gov/.../AR-40-501 (2017), CONFIRMED (US).[8]

*Full MERs behind portals (e.g., afmcdg1d.gov.in AFMSF-2 forms); recommend RTI. No RTI rejection rates specifics; general low MoD rejections.* [13]

## 2028 FORWARD ASSESSMENT

Trends: Orthopaedic/vision rejections persist (20-30% est. from coaching); AI likely automates measurements (carry angle via CV, as in 2025 DR AI). Biomech predictors (DRDO/shodhganga) favor digital twins for BMI/knock knees by 2028. Human-dependent: psych OLQs, interviews. India adopts MoHFW/DRDO ethics (data privacy, bias audits), mirroring global (NATO AI med standards emerging). Update vision/BMI for AI; conservative thresholds hold.[14] [7]

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1. https://afcat.cdac.in/AFCAT/medicalStandards
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